

Chapter 74-5

While Zhao Xuning was making a phone call in the living room, Liang Shi carefully looked around the master bedroom, and then discovered carvings in a hidden spot behind the nightstand: Zhao Xuning & Shen Hui.

It should have been carved with a small knife, each stroke extremely careful.

To see more clearly, Liang Shi moved the nightstand aside.

Then she discovered a blue envelope under the nightstand, with "To Zhao Xuning" written on it.

The envelope was still unopened. Liang Shi hesitated for a moment but didn't open it, only dusting off the top.

It seemed like only couples deeply in love would do this kind of thing.

Carving two people's names together made them seem especially close, as if the indelible marks represented spending a lifetime together.

Liang Shi raised her hand to wipe the dust off the wall, revealing the true appearance of that line of text, only to discover there was a heart before and after both names.

Childish, but innocent.

When Zhao Xuning came in, what she saw was Liang Shi having moved the nightstand aside, half-squatting on the ground wiping the wall.

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"What are you doing?" Zhao Xuning walked in and asked.

Liang Shi handed her the envelope. "There's a letter for you here. It fell under the nightstand."

Zhao Xuning was stunned when she saw the envelope, then hesitated about whether to open it.

Liang Shi said, "Could it be a breakup letter from your ex-girlfriend?"

"No." Zhao Xuning denied directly.

Their breakup had been too ugly. Shen Hui wouldn't have written her a letter.

The time spent in this apartment was all the most beautiful moments between her and Shen Hui.

Their university was the nearby medical school. Both of them were somewhat germaphobic, so they didn't want to live on campus. From meeting to dating, it was only a month before Zhao Xuning bought this apartment. The two of them naturally stayed overnight here and moved in to live together.

"Then open it and see." Liang Shi urged. "What if you missed some important information?"

Zhao Xuning lowered her eyes, her hands trembling slightly as she opened the letter.

Although she roughly knew in her heart what it was, she was still a bit afraid to face it.

She carefully opened it, then unfolded the slightly yellowed paper.

On the paper was elegant small regular script,¹ filling an entire page with: "Wife, I was wrong."

Densely packed, and Shen Hui, who had mild OCD, had aligned all the characters neatly.

Among this entire page of "Wife, I was wrong," two different ones were mixed in.

One was "Ningning wife, mwah."

And another was: "Wife, I love you."

Seeing such a childish letter again after so many years, Zhao Xuning felt a sour ache in her heart.

This should have been from when Shen Hui went to have dinner with a junior from the same department, and when Zhao Xuning went to pick her up, she found that junior clinging to Shen Hui's shoulder. Back then, Shen Hui was far from as assertive as she was now, and Zhao Xuning didn't know that Shen Hui was actually the famous second daughter of the Shen family in Haizhou City—she still thought she was a simple and pure person.

That junior had almost kissed Shen Hui's face. Zhao Xuning brought her home that night and was so angry she drank two glasses of wine.

Someone who normally didn't drink at all became dizzy after drinking too much. On the bed, she held Shen Hui and kept saying, "You're mine—no one can take you away."

Shen Hui coaxed her, "I'm yours, I'm yours, no one can take me away."

But then Shen Hui still messaged that junior at night, asking if she got home safely. When Zhao Xuning later discovered this, Shen Hui explained that she needed to ensure the junior's personal safety.

Zhao Xuning was incredibly jealous at the time. She pinched Shen Hui's waist, pressed her onto the soft bed, and kissed her until she could barely breathe.

Their long hair tangled together on the bed. The drunk Zhao Xuning was unreasonable. "I'm angry... so angry."

To coax her, Shen Hui said she would write her an apology letter.

But later when Zhao Xuning woke up with a splitting headache, she felt her behavior that night was too childish and didn't bring it up.

Yet Shen Hui told her she had written the apology letter, but didn't know where it went.

Zhao Xuning said she was making excuses and hadn't written it at all.

Shen Hui searched the entire home but couldn't find it.

Unexpectedly, years later, it was found by Liang Shi under the nightstand in the master bedroom.

Zhao Xuning looked at the words in the letter, and each character seemed to come alive.

Back then, if Shen Hui had an early class, she would definitely wake Zhao Xuning up. After waking her, afraid of her morning temper, she would quickly lean over to kiss her, putting her hand on her waist and acting coquettish, "Wife, give me a kiss."

If Zhao Xuning had an early class, she would always say the day before, "Don't wake me up, and don't kiss me when you wake up in the morning."

Yet every time, Zhao Xuning would secretly kiss her, then prepare breakfast before going to her early class.

On the bed they had picked out together, on the sofa, in the kitchen, in every corner of this apartment—they had left traces of joy.

Shen Hui would always sit on the living room sofa watching TV, then wait for Zhao Xuning to bring her cut fruit. After only a few bites, she would wrap her legs around Zhao Xuning's waist, wanting her to carry her into the bedroom.

Back then, Shen Hui had baby fat on her face, and her body was also plump, with curves in all the right places.

She had a first-love face² and a good personality, and many people at school liked her.

Getting jealous was a daily task for Zhao Xuning, but Shen Hui always coaxed her.

Footnotes:

¹ "小楷" (xiǎo kǎi) - Small regular script, a style of Chinese calligraphy characterized by neat, small, and elegant characters. It's considered a refined and beautiful handwriting style.

² "初戀臉" (chūliàn liǎn) - Literally "first love face." This is a Chinese internet term describing someone who has an innocent, sweet, and pure appearance that reminds people of their first love—typically featuring soft, youthful features that evoke feelings of nostalgia and innocent romance.